

# Polynomial Regression

A Polynomial regression is used when the relationship between  $X$  and  $Y$  is curved, not a straight line.

→ Linear regression draws a straight line

→ Polynomial regression draw a Curve

But internally, it is a linear regression

# Why do we need Polynomial Regression:-

Linear regression Assumes: When  $X$  increases by 1 unit,  $Y$  increases (decreases) by a constant amount.

→ But in real life, this is often not True

Example:- • Salary VS experience: Salary increases fast initially, then slows down.

• Sales VS advertising Spend: more ads helps, but after a point returns reduce

→ These relationships are curved, not straight, so linear regression fails

→ Polynomial regression does not change the algorithm

→ It only creates new features



Original feature:  $X$

Polynomial feature:  $X, X^2, X^3$

→ Linear regression:

$$Y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X$$

→ Polynomial regression (degree=2):

$$Y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X + \beta_2 X^2$$

→ Polynomial regression (degree=3):

$$Y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X + \beta_2 X^2 + \beta_3 X^3$$

• The curve comes because of  $X^2, X^3$  not because of  $X$

# Why it is still called a Linear regression:-

Because : →  $\beta_0, \beta_1, \beta_2$  appear linearly

→ No  $\beta$  is squared or multiplied with another  $\beta$

So : → linear in parameters

→ solved using same OLS formula

# Choosing the degree

- degree 1 → linear regression
- degree 2 → Simple curve
- degree 3+ → more bends